



HENRY VIII

England's Tudor king (reigned 1509–1547) imposed a series of repressive measures on religious houses that had a grave impact on the welfare of some musicians.

Little is known about Thomas Tallis's early life. There are claims that he came from Leicestershire or Kent, but the first known record dates from 1532, when he was an organist at Dover Priory. By 1537, Tallis had moved to the parish church of St. Mary-at-Hill in London. A year later, he transferred to Waltham Abbey, outside the capital.

This was probably a shrewd move. Religious houses were already being suppressed as part of Henry VIII's plan to take control of the Church of England, but the severance pay was